



Free ride

Instead of swimming around to find food, remoras can fasten themselves to larger fish, using a suckerlike pad on the tops of their heads. Sometimes they hitchhike alone, but here more than 20 have latched on to a fully grown whale shark and are using its immense muscle power to get a lift through the sea. Remoras remove parasites from the whale's skin to feed on and can unstick themselves whenever they want. They dart out to catch leftover food scraps or to feed on the waste that their host squirts into the water as it swims.